

» FABALES



1.5 m
5 ft

WILD LIQUORICE
Astragalus glycyphyllos
F: Fabaceae

With similar leaves to true liquorice, this European grassland herb has curved pods. It can be used as a tea.

BLUE FALSE INDIGO
Baptisia australis
F: Fabaceae

The sap of this herbaceous perennial, native to woods and streamsides in E. USA, turns purple when exposed to air, and is used as an indigo dye substitute.



40 m/130 ft

BLACK BEAN TREE
Castanospermum australe
F: Fabaceae

The orange-and-red flowers of this Australian timber tree develop into woody pods containing three to five bean-like seeds.



EVERGREEN LEAVES

15 m
50 ft



CAROB TREE
Ceratonia siliqua
F: Fabaceae

This Mediterranean tree has a thick trunk, dense foliage, and small, dull-green flowers. Pulp from the seed pods is a chocolate substitute.



young seed pod



CHICK PEA
Cicer arietinum
F: Fabaceae

One of the earliest cultivated vegetables from the Middle East, its seed pod contains one to three seeds, which can be cooked to make hummus.



JUDAS TREE
Cercis siliquastrum
F: Fabaceae

This deciduous, ornamental and timber tree from the E. Mediterranean flowers profusely in the spring, then later develops flat 10 cm (4 in) seed pods.



GOAT'S-RUE
Galega officinalis
F: Fabaceae

Naturalized in temperate areas, this perennial, with long, cylindrical, red-brown seed pods, is believed by some to improve lactation and reduce fevers and diabetes.



MOUNT ETNA BROOM
Genista aetnensis
F: Fabaceae

Native to Sicily, around the slopes of Mount Etna, and Sardinia, this small tree has few leaves; flattened green shoots assist photosynthesis.



PURPLISH-PINK FLOWER



SMALL-FLOWERED GORSE
Ulex parviflorus
F: Fabaceae

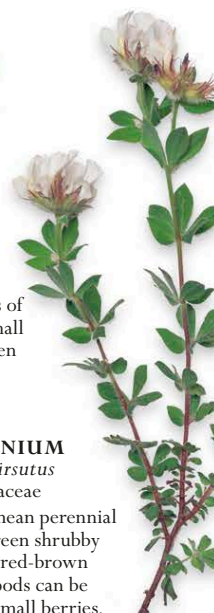
This dense, spiny, perennial shrub from the W. Mediterranean has yellow leaves and short, brown-black pods. Fire and brush clearance aid seed germination.

BROAD-LEAVED EVERLASTING PEA
Lathyrus latifolius
F: Fabaceae

Distributed through S. Europe and N. Africa, this vigorous, climbing perennial has winged stems and clusters of 5–15 pinkish flowers. Its seeds form in long pods.

DORYCNium
Lotus hirsutus
F: Fabaceae

This Mediterranean perennial forms grey-green shrubby mounds. Its red-brown cylindrical pods can be mistaken for small berries.



COMMON BIRD'S-FOOT TREFOIL
Lotus corniculatus
F: Fabaceae

Found in grassland in Europe, Asia, and Africa, it has yellow flowers and five lobed leaves, three of which sit above the others. Its seed pods resemble a bird's foot.



COMMON VETCH
Vicia sativa
F: Fabaceae

This scrambling, widespread annual is native to Europe and the Mediterranean. An animal-feed crop, its flowers are normally paired and its tendrils can be branched.

